



Audiocular M71 Music Player

Nails its purpose, but is it worth it?

Satvik Pandey | satvik@digit.in

There's a certain charm to devices that do one thing well. Remember the golden age of MP3 players? From the iPod Shuffle's minimalist vibes to the Sony Walkman's iconic style, these little gadgets once defined how we experienced music on the go. Fast forward to 2025, and they've mostly faded into obscurity, replaced by smartphones that can stream millions of songs at the touch of a button.

And yet, the Audiocular M71 steps into this landscape with a proposition:

a standalone MP3 player for those who want to focus solely on their music. It's a curious product – a mix of nostalgia and modern tech aimed at a niche audience. But does it offer enough to carve out its place in a world dominated by all-in-one devices? Or is it just a relic dressed up in Bluetooth and HiFi buzzwords? Let's break it down.

Design and build: Minimalist, for better or worse

The Audiocular M71 keeps things simple. It's lightweight, compact, and

built around a 2.4-inch touchscreen. The design is... fine. It's plastic, which isn't necessarily bad, but don't expect it to scream luxury. Available in black or grey, it's understated to the point where it could get lost in your bag if you're not careful.

It's functional, though, and maybe that's all it needs to be. If you're into a minimalist aesthetic or don't want something that distracts from its job, this might hit the sweet spot. But compared to today's sleek devices, it feels a bit, well, basic.

What's under the hood?

Here's where the M71 tries to stand out. With Bluetooth 5.3 for wireless audio, 32GB of built-in storage (expandable up to 128GB via microSD), and support for audio formats like MP3, WAV, and FLAC, it's got enough to satisfy most music lovers. High-fidelity audio support is a nice touch, especially if you're an audiophile who refuses to compromise on quality.

Beyond the audio features, there's a built-in FM radio, a HiFi speaker, dual headphone jacks (a surprising rarity nowadays), and even video playback. It also uses a USB Type-C port for charging, which is appreciated in 2025 – nobody wants to deal with micro-USB anymore.

On paper, the feature set seems solid, but there's a nagging question: How often are you going to use something like video playback on a 2.4-inch screen?

Real-world performance is solid but unremarkable

Let's get to the heart of the matter: how does it sound? Honestly, the M71 does a good job. Paired with the right headphones or speakers, it delivers crisp audio and holds its own against pricier devices. Bluetooth connectivity is reliable, and the range is decent. For those who still have a library of FLAC files sitting on their hard drive, it's refreshing to have a player that supports them without jumping through hoops. The user interface, though? It's service-